

US career guide / September 17, 2026 / 10 = best option

# 10 AI companies worth applying to

Real roles beyond engineering, with requirements, published pay and application links.

You don't have to write software to work at an AI company. These employers also need people who can sell, design, run campaigns, negotiate with suppliers and organize business operations.

## Choose work you can show

For each company: an exact job title, requirements, pay details, application links and an interview question. Use the suggested project to prepare your application.

### 1. Choose two roles

Find familiar work on page 2. Check the requirements: several openings are senior roles.

### 2. Compare the actual offers

Compare the location, office days and pay. Base salary excludes the commissions included in a sales earnings target.

### 3. Prepare one relevant example

Use the application prompts and comparison sheet at the end. Pick a project you can explain from the first decision to the result.

These postings don't list coding as a requirement. Technical knowledge may still be expected. Ask which interview tasks you'll need to complete.

Openings and pay can change. If a link has closed, use the company careers page and search the exact title or job ID shown in this guide.

# Find the work you already know

Ranks run from 1 to 10, with 10 the best option in this list. They compare career opportunities, not how easy it is to get hired.

|    |                     |                                              |
|----|---------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 01 | ElevenLabs          | Product design                               |
| 02 | ServiceNow          | Strategy, consulting and operations          |
| 03 | Snowflake           | Event content and marketing operations       |
| 04 | Amazon Web Services | Campaign and event marketing                 |
| 05 | OpenAI              | Sales, consulting and customer relationships |
| 06 | Microsoft           | Enterprise product marketing                 |
| 07 | Databricks          | Business events and partner marketing        |
| 08 | Anthropic           | Experienced technology sales                 |
| 09 | Google              | Consumer growth and paid advertising         |
| 10 | NVIDIA              | Procurement and supplier management          |

## How the order was chosen

I prioritized the experience you could gain, the strength of the business and the range of roles beyond engineering. This is my shortlist, not a ranking of salaries or employee satisfaction. Compare the specific team and offer before choosing an employer.

Pay ranges describe the specific openings shown here, not average pay at each company. Business results explain why an employer is worth considering, but they cannot tell you whether your particular team will be a good place to work.

### Begin with two applications

Choose two roles whose requirements you can support with real work. Read the full descriptions, prepare one relevant example for each and fill in the comparison sheet at the end.

# 01 ElevenLabs

My smaller-company choice if you want to design voice and audio products. You can apply with past projects and designs rather than a specific degree or a fixed number of years.

## Product Designer

Job ID: 89da00ec-11b0-4359-913b-c3a89c1013bc

Remote, including the United States. Optional offices include New York and San Francisco.

**What you need.** No formal experience, certification or degree requirement stated. Show problem-solving through past designs and projects. Figma examples welcomed. Engineering-constraint knowledge preferred.

**The work.** Design voice and audio experiences, define design standards and work with engineering, research and customer teams to launch features.

**Technical expectations.** Collaboration with frontend engineers and understanding engineering constraints. No coding requirement listed.

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### Compensation not disclosed

**Not published**

Ask for the salary range for your location, plus any bonus and stock. The posting does not provide those figures.

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**Your application example.** Choose a design project and show the problem, alternatives, feedback and final decision. Include what changed after people used it.

#### Ask the hiring team

"What is the cash range for my location, what are the equity terms, and what design work would I own during my first three months?"

**The tradeoff.** You'll need to explain your design decisions and work closely with engineers. Get the compensation range before committing to a lengthy interview assignment.

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ElevenLabs reported that large organizations account for 55% of revenue.

[Read job / apply](#) [Company careers](#) [Business source: 2026-09-08](#)

## 02 ServiceNow

A practical option for experienced consultants and operations professionals. You would help an AI product team decide where to invest, what to prioritize and how to measure the results.

### AI Product Strategy & Operation Senior Manager

Job ID: JB0075055 / 744000146538969

Santa Clara, California. Listed as flexible or remote. Eligibility may depend on your residence relative to an office.

**What you need.** The posting says at least 8-10 years in consulting, investing, technology strategy/operations or similar work. Quantitative analysis and executive communication expected. No degree requirement listed.

**The work.** Review revenue, costs and customer trends, support product planning and evaluate whether to build, buy or partner.

**Technical expectations.** Technical discussions expected. Enterprise software product or strategy experience preferred. No coding requirement listed.

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#### Published base pay

**\$165,500-\$289,600**

USD, plus variable pay and equity when applicable. The posting does not specify the pay period. Ask the recruiter to confirm the annual base amount and additional compensation.

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**Your application example.** Choose a decision you supported with numbers. Explain the alternatives, the cost, your recommendation and the result.

#### Ask the hiring team

"Which decisions would I make, which would I advise on, and what would I be expected to produce in the first three months?"

**The tradeoff.** This is a senior role. Experience can also become tied to one software platform, so ask which decisions and skills will carry to other employers.

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ServiceNow reported that the annual value of its AI contracts exceeded \$1 billion.

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## 03 Snowflake

A useful choice if you've managed event content and the people needed to deliver it. You would coordinate sessions, speakers and approvals, then reuse that material for webinars and other customer programs.

### Sr. Product Marketing Manager - Event Content

Job ID: REQ20318

Menlo Park, California. Hybrid. Ask how many office days are required.

**What you need.** The posting uses '2-5+ years' in business-event operations, content operations or marketing-program execution. Event systems, AI workflow automation and concurrent-program experience. No degree requirement listed.

**The work.** Manage event-content production, coordinate speakers and rehearsals, and adapt event material for webinars and follow-on campaigns.

**Technical expectations.** AI workflow tools, event systems and audiovisual coordination. No coding requirement listed.

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#### Annual base salary

**\$165,000-\$216,300**

USD. Bonus and equity plans are additional. Confirm the range for your location and ask how the bonus is calculated.

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**Your application example.** Show how you managed content deadlines, speakers and approvals across an event. Include a specific change that improved delivery.

#### Ask the hiring team

"How much time is spent on product messaging versus event logistics, and how many simultaneous events would I manage?"

**The tradeoff.** The job title includes product marketing, but the responsibilities emphasize event-content operations. Compare the actual work with your interests before applying.

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Snowflake reported \$1.49 billion in quarterly product revenue, up 37% year over year. It also reported an operating loss.

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## 04 Amazon Web Services

AWS gives marketers a way to work with cloud and AI customers. This opening runs campaigns for business events, including AWS Summits, and measures who attends and how campaigns perform.

### Campaign Manager, AWS Marketing Event Demand Generation

Job ID: 10513664

Seattle, Washington. On-site. Confirm the weekly office schedule before applying.

**What you need.** 4+ years of professional marketing experience, excluding internships. Campaign execution, Excel analysis and performance measurement required. No degree requirement listed.

**The work.** Run campaigns across channels, coordinate event audiences and analyze registrations, attendance and marketing performance.

**Technical expectations.** Excel and marketing systems such as Marketo or Salesforce. No coding requirement listed.

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#### Annual base salary

**\$82,700-\$141,100**

USD for Seattle. Sign-on payments and company stock are additional. Ask when each payment is made, when the stock vests and whether a sign-on payment must be repaid if you leave.

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**Your application example.** Show a campaign from planning to reporting. Explain which channels you chose, what you measured and how you changed the campaign.

#### Ask the hiring team

"Which campaigns would I own, how much of the portfolio covers AI, and how do you judge quality beyond registrations?"

**The tradeoff.** The campaigns cover cloud computing as well as AI. Ask which audiences and events you would handle, and confirm the on-site schedule.

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AWS reported \$42.2 billion in quarterly sales, up 37% year over year.

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## 05 OpenAI

Consider OpenAI if you have sales, finance or consulting experience with business customers. This role develops your ability to understand a customer's needs and help them make a buying decision.

### Account Associate - SF

Job ID: 55f36629-8351-41d9-b2f5-3d63c5e26bf7

San Francisco, California. Hybrid, Monday through Wednesday in office. Relocation assistance offered.

**What you need.** 4+ years in enterprise sales or strategic customer-facing finance/consulting work. Record of exceeding targets and strong executive communication. No degree requirement listed.

**The work.** Find prospective customers, investigate their needs, map decision-makers and support account plans and deals.

**Technical expectations.** Speak with technical buyers and use AI tools for prospecting. No coding requirement listed.

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### Annual base salary

**\$144,000-\$160,000**

USD, with equity offered. Ask whether there is additional variable pay. This salary range and Anthropic's target earnings include different things, so compare the base salaries separately.

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**Your application example.** Prepare an account or consulting example where you found the real buyer, understood the business problem and helped reach a commercial decision.

#### Ask the hiring team

"Which parts of the sales cycle would I own, how is performance measured, and what changed for the last person promoted from this role?"

**The tradeoff.** Associate does not mean entry-level here. Ask which parts of a deal you would own and what you would need to demonstrate before moving into a larger sales role.

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OpenAI reported that its products reach 2.5 million businesses.

[Read full job](#) [Apply](#) [Company careers](#) [Business source: 2026-09-08](#)

## 06 Microsoft

A useful target if you can explain technology to business leaders and help customers use it. This Copilot opening combines writing, customer research and product marketing.

### Senior Product Marketing Manager, Copilot Adoption- AI Leader

Job ID: 200049603

Redmond, Washington, or Mountain View, California. Three office days per week. Less than 25% travel.

**What you need.** Master's plus 3+ years of business experience, bachelor's plus 5+ years, or equivalent experience. Marketing, business and related degrees qualify. Higher experience and executive communication are preferred.

**The work.** Explain Copilot to business leaders, create adoption materials and use customer research to improve programs.

**Technical expectations.** Understand enterprise technology and AI adoption. A computer-science degree is one option, not a mandatory qualification. No coding requirement listed.

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#### Annual base salary

**\$106,400-\$203,600**

USD. Mountain View uses the higher Bay Area range: \$137,600-\$222,600 per year. Confirm the range for your location, plus any bonus and stock, in writing.

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**Your application example.** Use a project where your explanation or rollout plan helped customers use a product. Separate what you wrote from what customers did afterward.

#### Ask the hiring team

"What change in customer adoption would I own, and what evidence would show that my work caused an improvement?"

**The tradeoff.** You'll need to explain complex technology clearly to executives. Check which decisions this team owns and how it works with product, sales and research teams.

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Microsoft reported more than 30 million paid Microsoft 365 Copilot seats.

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## 07 Databricks

Databricks makes software for managing data and building AI applications. This role suits marketers who can connect events to customer conversations.

### Event Marketing Manager, 3P & Partner

Job ID: 8638637002 / MKTQ327R28

United States. Confirm the work location, office schedule and remote eligibility with the recruiter.

**What you need.** Experience leading complex business events, managing budgets and measuring sales results. No degree or fixed number of years is specified.

**The work.** Plan partner and third-party events, improve qualified sales opportunities and use attendee feedback and performance data to adjust spending.

**Technical expectations.** Marketing measurement and forecasting. No programming requirement listed.

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#### Advertised pay by location

**Zone 1: \$120,400-\$165,550**

Zone 2: \$108,400-\$149,050    Zone 3: \$102,300-\$140,700    Zone 4: \$96,300-\$132,450

USD. Use the pay-zone map below to find your state. Ask whether your range is base salary or includes target commissions. No commission plan is specified for this role. Bonus and equity may be additional.

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**Your application example.** Choose an event and connect its budget and attendance to qualified customer conversations. Explain how you measured the result.

#### Ask the hiring team

"How do you measure an event's contribution to sales, and which parts of that result would I be responsible for?"

**The tradeoff.** You'll be expected to connect events to sales results, not only attendance. The role asks for proven event leadership even though it does not specify a number of years.

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Databricks reported an annualized revenue pace above \$7 billion in August 2026. This projects a recent sales pace over a year.

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## 08 Anthropic

A strong choice if you already sell technology and want to work directly with customers adopting Claude. You would own the sales process from the first conversation through launch.

### Account Executive, Startups

Job ID: 5400138008 / requisition 3356

San Francisco or New York City. Office attendance required. The company minimum is 25% in-office, and some roles require more. Confirm this team's schedule.

**What you need.** 4+ years prospecting and closing startup customers. Consultative technology sales, commercial negotiation and a record of exceeding quota. Bachelor's or equivalent education, training and/or experience.

**The work.** Find potential customers, run sales conversations through launch, negotiate agreements and bring customer feedback to product teams.

**Technical expectations.** Explain AI models to technical buyers and understand their requirements. No programming requirement listed.

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#### On-target earnings, not base

**\$222,800-\$290,000**

Annual USD on-target earnings (OTE): base salary plus commissions or bonuses if you meet the sales target. The base amount is not disclosed. Ask for the guaranteed salary and variable pay separately.

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**Your application example.** Prepare a deal you won. Explain how you found the buyer, understood the problem, handled objections and reached an agreement.

#### Ask the hiring team

"What is the base salary, what percentage of comparable sellers reached quota, and how are accounts assigned during the first year?"

**The tradeoff.** Part of your pay depends on sales results. Ask about the target, the accounts you would receive and how long new sellers have before they must meet the full target.

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Anthropic reported a \$47 billion annualized revenue pace in May 2026. That projects a recent sales pace over a year, rather than reporting a completed year's revenue.

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## 09 Google

Google offers careers in consumer AI and cloud software for businesses. This Gemini opening fits marketers who know how to run paid campaigns and test which messages bring in customers.

### Gemini Performance Marketing Manager

Job ID: 132819426826166982

New York, Mountain View or San Francisco. Ask the recruiter about office days. The posting does not specify a schedule.

**What you need.** 4 years in consumer performance marketing, digital media or user acquisition. Bachelor's degree or equivalent practical experience. End-to-end paid-media campaign experience required.

**The work.** Run Gemini advertising campaigns, coordinate creative work and localization, test alternatives and explain campaign results.

**Technical expectations.** Campaign measurement and AI productivity tools. No programming requirement listed.

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#### Listed salary range

**\$116,000-\$166,000**

USD, plus a 15% target bonus, equity and benefits. The posting does not state the pay period. Ask the recruiter to confirm annual base pay for your location.

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**Your application example.** Choose a campaign you ran. Show the audience, budget, test, result and the decision you made because of the data.

#### Ask the hiring team

"Which acquisition or retention result would I own, and what budget and creative support would I have to improve it?"

**The tradeoff.** You'll need evidence from campaigns you've run. Confirm the office schedule and which campaign decisions you would make yourself.

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Alphabet reported 950 million monthly active users for the Gemini app.

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# 10 NVIDIA

My top choice for its established AI infrastructure business and the range of work needed to support it. If you've managed suppliers and contracts, this opening gives you a way to use that experience at an AI company.

## Manager, Strategic Sourcing - Marketing, Events, Professional Services

Job ID: JR2005705

Santa Clara, California. On-site. Full-time.

**What you need.** 10+ years of business experience and 2+ years of leadership. Bachelor's in business, marketing or a related field, or equivalent experience. Global marketing/events sourcing experience required. MBA or similar expertise preferred.

**The work.** Choose and manage marketing and event suppliers, develop sourcing plans, negotiate commercial terms and improve purchasing costs.

**Technical expectations.** Procurement analysis and knowledge of a technology business. No programming requirement listed.

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### Published base salary

**\$168,000-\$270,250**

USD for this Santa Clara opening. Equity and benefits are additional. Ask whether the offer includes a bonus and how the stock vests.

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**Your application example.** Explain a supplier decision: the budget, the alternatives, what you negotiated and what happened after the contract was signed.

#### Ask the hiring team

"Which supplier categories would I own, and what savings or service improvements would you expect in my first six months?"

**The tradeoff.** This job supports marketing and events rather than developing AI products. It also requires senior experience and working on-site in Santa Clara.

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NVIDIA reported \$96.2 billion in revenue for the quarter ended July 26, 2026.

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# Turn your experience into an application

Choose a real project. Write down what you personally did before changing your resume.

## 1. Match the work, not only the title

Take three responsibilities from the posting. For each one, identify something you have done, evidence you can discuss and any experience you still need.

### Example for an event-marketing application

"I owned [event or campaign], worked with [teams], managed [budget or deadline] and measured [result]. I changed [decision] because [evidence]."

Replace the brackets with facts. Leave out numbers you cannot support and confidential details from your employer.

## 2. Bring a sample that fits the job

For marketing, use a campaign and the decisions behind it. For sales, explain a customer problem and how you reached an agreement. For design, show alternatives and user feedback. For operations or sourcing, explain a decision about cost, suppliers or delivery.

You can describe confidential work at a high level. Don't send internal reports, customer lists or private designs without permission.

## 3. Ask about the actual hiring process

"Does the interview include coding or another technical exercise? What would I be expected to produce in the first three months?"

Ask which tools and technical concepts you should be ready to use. Prepare for the job's actual assessment.

## 4. Send a specific note

"I'm interested in [exact role and job ID]. My relevant experience is [one sentence about real work]. The posting mentions [responsibility]. Does that include [specific question]?"

Use the official application link. You do not need a personal introduction to read the requirements or submit an application.

If an opening is too senior, use the company careers page to search the same kind of work at your experience level. Check the current requirements before applying.

# Compare the money before the names

Ask for a written breakdown for the exact level and location in your offer.

## 1. Separate salary from sales targets

On-target earnings, or OTE, include base salary plus commissions or bonuses for meeting a target. Anthropic lists target earnings. OpenAI lists salary. Ask for the guaranteed salary separately before comparing them.

"What is the base salary? What is the target variable pay, and what percentage of people in this role earned it last year?"

## 2. Get the location and pay period right

Microsoft and Databricks publish different ranges by location. Use the range for where you would work. For every offer, ask the recruiter to confirm the annual base salary, currency and additional compensation in writing.

## 3. Read the stock terms

Ask what you receive, when it vests, what you must pay to exercise options and whether you can sell the shares. A private-company valuation does not make your equity spendable cash. Public shares can also lose value.

"Can you show my cash, bonus target and stock vesting separately for each of the first four years? What happens to unvested shares if I leave?"

## 4. Include the cost of taking the job

Check office days, travel, relocation, health coverage, retirement contributions and any sign-on repayment clause. Ask about after-hours expectations and the manager's actual team practices.

For ElevenLabs, request the compensation range before committing to a lengthy interview assignment. The design posting does not publish it.

### A number you can compare

Write down guaranteed first-year cash separately from variable pay and stock. Then compare roles at similar levels in locations where you can work.

# Compare your two real options

Print this page or copy the prompts into your notes. Write "unknown" when you need an answer from the hiring team.

| What to find out                                   | Option A | Option B |
|----------------------------------------------------|----------|----------|
| Company, exact title and job ID                    |          |          |
| Location, office days and travel                   |          |          |
| Three responsibilities I can support with examples |          |          |
| Required experience I still need                   |          |          |
| Annual base / target bonus or commissions          |          |          |
| Stock terms and first-year cash                    |          |          |
| Interview tasks and first 90-day expectations      |          |          |
| Application date and next action                   |          |          |

## Make one concrete decision

Choose the application you can support best today. Prepare the example named on that company's page, then use its official application link.

Job and company sources are linked on each company page. Openings can change. No endorsement by the listed employers is implied.